

When recruiting outpaces the curriculum, legal education suffers.

A resolution on accelerated law-firm recruiting.

WHAT WE ASK YOU TO ADOPT

A resolution urging law schools, private legal employers, bar associations, and other stakeholders to:

1. **Study** how accelerating recruitment timelines affect legal education, student well-being, and the entry-level hiring market; and
2. **Consider**, in their own recruitment practices and policies, the educational, professional, and equitable interests of law students.

75%

of surveyed students tie rising anxiety directly to recruiting pressure

85%

of offers now made before July of 1L, up from 34% a year earlier

18

law schools asked the ABA to act

WHY IT MATTERS

- A majority of surveyed Class of 2028 students say the accelerated timeline hurt them.
- Students now commit to a firm before their first grades, before legal writing is finished, before any clinic or elective.
- No single firm can slow down alone — whoever waits loses candidates to whoever moves first.

Resolution 403 is the first step out.

THREE CONCERNS, ONE MODEST RESPONSE

Student well-being.

Consequential decisions land before students sit for a single exam, deepening the anxiety already reshaping 1L.

Equity and access.

Only 25% of students knew these timelines before enrolling.

Hiring-market health.

Employers hire on less information — a “lose-lose-lose” no one can fix alone.

The students asked first. On January 1, 2026, student governments at 18 law schools (Columbia, Cornell, Duke, Georgetown, Harvard, Michigan, Northwestern, NYU, Penn, Stanford, Texas, UC Berkeley, UCLA, Chicago, Virginia, Vanderbilt, WashU, and Yale) jointly asked the ABA to review accelerating recruitment, several backed by student polls showing supermajority support. **Sponsored by the Bar Association of the District of Columbia, with a coalition of law schools.** Approved by the BADC Board of Directors and recommended by its Young Lawyers Section; the drafters are aware of no opposition.



Please vote to ADOPT Resolution 403.

Scan for the full resolution, the report, the data, the coalition, and sources, at legal-recruiting-timeline-initiative.github.io/law-student-hiring-resolution

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Sources: NALP, *Perspectives on 2025 Law Student Recruiting* (Jan. 2026); LSAC & NALP, *2025 1L Class: Student Awareness and Impact of Accelerated Big Law Recruitment* (June 2026); Law.com (June 11, 2026); Bloomberg Law (Dec. 11, 2025); ABA Journal (May 14, 2026). Full citations at the site above. Builds on existing ABA policy 23A523 and 24A515.